

capturing immediate interest. "Who wouldn't be interested if they're paying more than four thousand a year in taxes?" he says. "Of course, I have to substantiate that statement in my presentation."

Likewise, in Shafiroff's initial approach he emphasizes that he deals in values. He stresses, "Wherever those values may be, and in whatever markets those values may be, my main concern is finding them for you: I also concentrate on special situations, seeking out companies with low multiples, high dividends, significant book values, and the possibility of realizing substantial capital gains." Shafiroff explains that he doesn't sell a specific stock during his first contact with a prospect. "I merely introduce myself and talk to him about my investment philosophy to see if it's in harmony with his. If we're not conceptually on the same wavelength, then I don't have anything to sell him."

Rodgers points out that the IBM cold-call approach creates initial interest by making a statement: "We're in the business of trying to provide solutions to a variety of different problems. Technology is moving very fast today, and I deal with many companies similar to yours, Mr. Prospect, where the use of our equipment has improved their profits. All we're trying to do at IBM is enhance productivity. For instance, our machines may accomplish this by enabling your volume to grow without having to increase your manpower. However, in order to take advantage of our equipment, there are a few things I have to know about your company." Then, soon into the presentation, a fact-finding session occurs.

During his initial approach, Baker mentions the names of several of his satisfied customers. This is done to establish credibility that his product has been well received by prominent people in the community. The five sales experts agree that this is an important procedure because it lets the prospect know that your product has benefited leading businesspersons who have good judgment. Shafiroff, who still makes it a practice to make six calls every day, claims that his best receptions are from those prospects